Travis Gautier

AI Engineer · Agent orchestration and evaluation · Founder, PrairieTech LLC

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SUMMARY

I have 15 years experience in the industry. From web development, to .NET automation, to network admin to healthcare IT. For 3 of those I've been teaching high school computer programming. Since November of 2025 though, I've been writing and releasing software to production by orchestrating a team of AI coding agents. Not trusting AI but measuring its output. Using a test-first process with 34 composable skills, 9 hooks to enforce quality and having between 4-8 agents running at once. Using this process I've built an entire SaaS product solo. And I'm writing about what I'm learning in public.

AI ENGINEERING WORK

Founder and AI Solutions Architect · PrairieTech LLC, Wichita KS (remote) Jul 2023 – Present

- Party Masters CRM (Nov 2025 – present): a booking, quoting, payments and scheduling platform for a 20-year Arizona DJ and rental operator, replacing a legacy PHP system that cost him 50+ hours a month. Next.js, PostgreSQL, Stripe. Built solo with an agent team: 4,796 test files and 266,394 lines of production code by month four. He paid, and hired me for the next project.
- Designed the delivery pipeline the agents run in. Each feature section moves through discovery (YAML contracts for dependencies, interfaces and test cases), failing tests, implementation, refactor, and finish. Every phase is a separate skill that works alone, and the orchestrator composes them.
- Enforcement lives in hooks, not prompts: 9 shell hooks gate phase transitions, YAML state validity, git operations and session start, so an agent cannot skip red for green or commit outside its section.
- Parallelism: four to eight agents at once, each claiming a private git worktree with a pidfile liveness marker, rebasing onto main under a lock, and re-running the gates before merge. Roughly 300 lines of skill files. A sanitized copy of the harness is available on request.
- Measurement. Token autopsy of a typical 850-turn, ~152K-token pipeline run to find where context goes (38.4% / 32.8% / 27.8% across the three largest buckets) and which levers are worth pulling. Test-quality study across 25 then 9 TDD sections when the model changed: mean tests per section moved from 16.8 to 68.8. Permission scan of 50 transcripts: 707 approval prompts collapsed to 6 rules.
- Client-facing outcomes: quotes that took 20 to 30 minutes now take under 10. Of the 25 changes he requested after the first release, 21 shipped before the next. Left him runbooks for backups and restore, incident response, secret rotation, and a SOC 2 controls map.
- travisgautier.com: Next.js 16 brand site and storefront, plus a Python content pipeline where model-drafted posts (OpenAI-compatible chat API, provider switchable) pass a deterministic gate (banned phrases, unregistered numbers, retired brand strings) before a human approves anything.

Public work 2026 – Present

- Substack essays on running an agent team for real client work: the token autopsy, parallel-agent plumbing, the test-quality shift between model versions, permission tuning. substack.com/@travisgautier · @TravisGautier on X

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Client Support Specialist · Hutchinson Regional Healthcare System, Hutchinson KS Apr 2024 – Present

- Help desk and server support. ManageEngine administration with deployment and patching through Endpoint Central. Head administrator for BeyondTrust remote support: access policy, technician accounts,

session auditing.

Computer Technology Instructor and Esports Head Coach · Lyons High School, USD 405 Sep 2021 – Apr 2024

- Taught web design and programming, Unity, Blender and Adobe, and CompTIA ITF+ and A+ prep. Launched the first esports program in a Kansas 3A district and secured collegiate scholarships for students.

Computer Technician · USD 405, Lyons KS Sep 2019 – Apr 2024

- District network and roughly 700 laptops: Windows Server, Active Directory, DHCP, firewalls, ZENworks, patching, backups and restores.

Freelance Web Developer · Self-employed, South-Central Kansas May 2015 – Jul 2023

- Websites and web apps for individuals, artists and small businesses, from Angular and Bootstrap to React and Next.js. Folded into PrairieTech LLC in 2023.

.NET Developer (Student Contractor) · National Institute for Aviation Research, Wichita KS Sep 2015 – Feb 2016

- Built from scratch an automation program used daily by aerospace engineers for quoting, test scheduling, data collection and report generation, in VB.NET and SQL.

Earlier: Web Developer Intern, LogicMaze Marketing (2015) · Insurance Agent, Washington National (2016 – 2017) · Technical Support, USD 405 (2013 – 2014) · Delivery Manager, Mike's Rent to Own (2011 – 2015) · Electrician, Gulf South Electric and Solar, New Orleans (2010 – 2011).

SKILLS

Agent engineering: Claude Code, Codex CLI, skills and hooks, subagents, worktree isolation, orchestration patterns, context and token budgeting, MCP

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Bash, SQL, C#, VB.NET, PowerShell, PHP, Java

Testing: TDD, Jest, Vitest, Playwright, MSW, coverage gates

Models and evaluation: Anthropic and OpenAI APIs, open-weight models (Kimi K3), test-per-section metrics, token autopsies, transcript analysis, deterministic lint gates for LLM output

Web and data: Next.js, React, Node, Tailwind, PostgreSQL, Prisma, Drizzle, Stripe, REST, webhooks, Zod

Ops and security: Docker, Linux, CI/CD, Sentry, backups and DR, secret rotation, SOC 2 controls, Windows Server, Active Directory, Azure, Microsoft 365

EDUCATION AND AWARDS

Computer Science coursework · Fort Hays State University, Hays KS · Kansas / ESSDACK teaching pathway for industry professionals 2022 – 2024

A.A. Computer Science · Hutchinson Community College, Hutchinson KS 2012 – 2015

SkillsUSA Web Design Competition · 1st place Kansas, 3rd place Nationals 2015